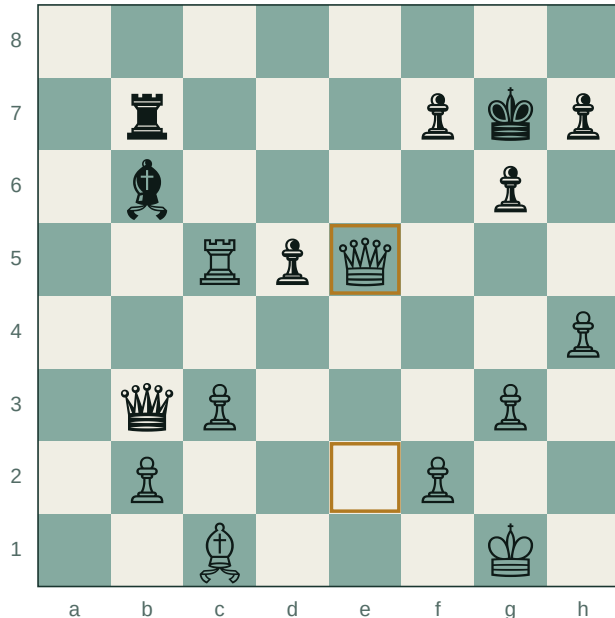


Active defensive resources: Black, move 33

Active defensive resources

Black to move



Previous move: 33.Qe5+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

33...f6 34. Bh6+ Kxh6 35. Qf4+ Kg7

33...f6 The pawn moves from f7 to f6. Recorded reply: **34.Bh6+**.

34...Kxh6 The king captures the bishop on h6. Recorded reply: **35.Qf4+**.

35...Kg7 The king moves from h6 to g7.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 21 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from -1 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A defensive puzzle may aim to preserve equality rather than win. Judge success against the threat, not only the final material count.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

The best defense may create a threat, exchange an attacker, or change the geometry of the attack. Identify the opponent's concrete idea before selecting a response.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the threatened move and the conditions it requires. Look for a move that breaks one of those conditions with tempo.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on e5 and rook on c5. Check for tactical protection.